

● Synapse

Connect a Shopify store — end-to-end setup & test guide

What this is for. The store you create here is a **test fixture**, not part of the product. Its only job is to let you click through the real connect flow once and confirm every link works. In production, each real founder connects *their own* store and the app reads *their* data — nothing about your store is hardcoded anywhere. The dashboard always reads whichever store the current visitor connected (via a signed session cookie).

Does it work on a completely empty store?

Connecting: yes — OAuth doesn't care whether the store has data. The connection succeeds either way.

Getting a customized answer: needs a little data. With zero orders the data pull comes back empty and the engine falls back to the built-in demo example, so you'd see a generic answer instead of *your* store. Real founders never hit this — their stores already have months of orders. For *your* test store, add ~5 fake orders (see the last section) so the real path actually fires.

1. Create the store

A Shopify **development store** via Shopify Partners is ideal — free, no billing. If you created it through `partners.shopify.com` you already have the Partners account needed for step 3.

2. Shopify Partners account

`partners.shopify.com` — free. Your dev store lives under it.

3. Create the app & get the keys

In the **Partners dashboard**:

- **Apps** → **Create app** → **Create app manually** → name it "Synapse".
- Open the app → **Client credentials** (a.k.a. API keys). Copy:
 - **Client ID** → this is `SHOIFY_API_KEY`
 - **Client secret** → this is `SHOIFY_API_SECRET`

4. Set the App URL + redirect (must match exactly)

In the app → **Configuration**:

- **App URL:** `https://synapse-acceleration.vercel.app`
- **Allowed redirection URL(s):** `https://synapse-acceleration.vercel.app/api/auth/shopify/callback`

The redirect string must be character-for-character exact, or Shopify rejects the callback.

5. Add env vars to Vercel — then redeploy

This is the one part only you can do. These go on the Vercel project that serves `synapse-acceleration.vercel.app` (your teammate's project), not just your local machine.

In that project's **Settings** → **Environment Variables**, add:

Name	Value
<code>SHOPIFY_API_KEY</code>	the Client ID from step 3
<code>SHOPIFY_API_SECRET</code>	the Client secret from step 3
<code>APP_URL</code>	<code>https://synapse-acceleration.vercel.app</code>

Scopes default to `read_orders, read_customers, read_products, read_reports` already — you don't need to set `SHOPIFY_SCOPES` unless you want to change them. Then **Redeploy** (env vars only take effect on a new deploy).

6. Test the flow

1. Go to `https://synapse-acceleration.vercel.app/dashboard`
2. In the Shopify card, type `your-store.myshopify.com` → **Connect**
3. Shopify shows an approve screen (proves keys + redirect are right) → approve
4. You land back on `/dashboard?connected=shopify`; the card shows **• Connected** with your shop name
5. **Ask Synapse** is now live against your real store data

Until those env vars are set + deployed, the Shopify card shows **"Connection coming soon"** instead of the connect box — that's the graceful fallback, not a bug.

To actually see real numbers — add a little data

Quickest way on a dev store:

1. Add **2–3 products** (Products → Add product).
2. Place a **few test orders** with the **Bogus Gateway**: Settings → Payments → add "(for testing) Bogus Gateway", then order through your storefront using card number `1 ( 2 / 3` simulate failures).

Even ~5 orders across the last week or two is enough for the Ask to reason about *your* store (revenue, top product, channel mix) instead of falling back to the demo example.

The mental model.

Production reality: a user connects their store → their data → their answer. Already built.

Your test store: the one store you can legitimately connect to confirm that reality works before the event — and it needs a sprinkle of data only because it starts empty.